RRC POLYTECH

RRC Polytech campuses are located on the lands of the Anishinaabeg, Ininiwak, Anishininwak, Dakota Oyate, and Denésuline, and the National Homeland of the Red River Métis.

Course Outline

Course Information

Course Code and Title: COMM-5065 Development and Narrative Design 3

Department: Creative Arts

Program: Game Development

Total Hours: 45 hours

Credit Hours: 3

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

This is the third of four Development and Narrative Design courses and is a shared course for both game artists and programmers. Development and Narrative Design 3 explores the core concepts of the game design process. Evaluating a game, and all its components, allows game developers to determine areas of strength, weakness, and opportunities for improvement or new game elements. Students will explore topics such as designing for accessibility, gameplay conventions and genres, and the roles of AI and camera placement in game design.

RECOGNITION OF PRIOR LEARNING (RPL):

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) refers to a set of processes that allow individuals to document, be assessed and gain recognition for their prior learning. The focus is on the learning rather than where or how the learning occurred. Knowledge, skills and abilities gained from life experiences may be formal (transfer credit), informal or non-formal. RRC Polytech evaluates and grants credit for qualifying prior learning that is equivalent to the learning outcomes for courses in a program. For more information about RPL at RRC Polytech, refer to RPL or Policy A14 – RPL.

Contact Chris Brower at cbrower@rrc.ca for information regarding RPL processes and opportunities for this course.

For general information and assistance with RPL, contact RRC Polytech's RPL Advisor at 204.632.3094 or rpladvisor@rrc.ca.

ACCESSIBILITY STATEMENT:

RRC Polytech is committed to providing persons with documented disabilities fair and equal access to educational programs, services and facilities. If you are a student with a disability* and require reasonable accommodations, you must connect with Student Accessibility Services (SAS) who will assist in developing and implementing your accommodation plan. Refer to the Student Accessibility Services webpage for information about SAS locations and how to book an appointment. Students with disabilities are also encouraged to have a private discussion with their instructor(s) to facilitate greater understanding of their learning needs.

*"Disability" refers to a condition that limits a person's daily activities. Persons with disabilities may have long-term physical, mental, intellectual or sensory impacts which may hinder their participation on an equal basis with others. A disability includes those related to or caused by aging, an injury or other life events that may temporarily or permanently affect mobility, dexterity (use of hands), vision, hearing, communication, understanding or mental health.

ALTERNATE FORMATS:

This content is available in alternate formats. To request, please contact accessibility@rrc.ca.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY:

Academic Integrity means acting with the values of honesty, trust, respect, responsibility, fairness and courage in learning, teaching and research to ensure that the credentials granted by RRC Polytech accurately represent demonstrated knowledge, skills and abilities. All members of the RRC Polytech community are expected to demonstrate these values through RRC Polytech learning activities, relationships and commitments. Clear expectations will be communicated to students to promote positive academic practices in compliance with RRC Polytech's Policy A17 – Academic Integrity. Contact academicintegrity@rrc.ca for additional information.

COURSE DELIVERY METHODS:

This course is delivered in a classroom environment. Courses may also be delivered online, or in a blended manner should needs arise.

The following communication tools will be used in this course:

- Academic Email
- MS Teams (Video Lectures and Chat Channels)
- Learn News Postings

Course format:

Students will work through guided projects to gain a working knowledge of concepts. Projects may also be completed as part of a team. Class time will be a mix of instruction, lab time, work periods, and in-class marking periods.

EFFECTIVE DATE:

August 25, 2025

Instructor Information

Instructor's name:	Chris Pointon
Email:	cpointon@rrc.ca
Office location:	W302
Office hours:	Office hours by appointment. Please email or message using Teams.

Student Readiness

TECHNOLOGY AND EQUIPMENT READINESS:

Each student will be assigned their own classroom desktop computer with all the software installed needed for the program.

For online delivery students should have their own personal:

- Webcam and microphone
- Headset (ear bud type not recommended)
- 1 TB external hard drive (Samsung T5 1TB model recommended)
- High speed internet connection minimum 10 Mbps download, 3 Mbps upload speed

Off-campus computer system specification guide:

This list represents the minimum hardware spec for a desktop computer system used for developing games with Unreal Engine 5:

- Windows 11 64-bit
- 32 or 64 GB RAM
- 512 GB SSD (OS Drive)
- 2 TB SSD (Data Drive)
- Nvidia GeForce RTX 3070 or better
- Minimum Six-Core AMD or Intel processor

STUDENT COMMITMENTS AND CONTACT TIMES:

- 3 hours scheduled daytime attendance per week.
- Students are expected to commit time outside of regularly scheduled classes to work on their challenges and their course projects.
- Students in this course are expected to regularly check the course MS Teams channels.
- Students in this course are expected to regularly check their academic email account or ensure it is forwarded to another checked account.
- Instructors will notify students at the beginning of the term of any course-specific communication methods

COURSE RESOURCES:

Textbook(s):

There is no textbook for this course.

References:

Course reference materials will be provided through Learn.

LEARNING OUTCOMES AND ELEMENTS OF PERFORMANCE:

By the end of this course of study, you should be able to:

1. Designing for accessibility
2. Design for systemic gameplay.
3. Design gameplay mechanics.
4. Describe the role of AI in game design.
5. Design for camera placement for gameplay and story clarity.
6. Identify gameplay conventions and genres.

INSTRUCTIONAL SCHEDULE, ASSESSMENTS AND DATES:

NOTE: The following dates are subject to change based on the needs of the students at the instructor's prerogative. Students will be notified ahead of time of any changes.

DATE	TOPIC OR IMPORTANT EVENT	LEARNING OUTCOME	ASSESSMENT EVALUATION	WEIGHT
Aug 28	Introduction			
Sept 4	Twine overview 1	2	**A1:** Twine game	35%
Sept 11	Twine overview 2	2, 3		
Sept 18	Work class			
Sept 25	Title Sequence Introduction	5	**A2:** Title Sequence **A1 DUE**	35%
Oct 2	Genres (lecture & discussion)	6		
Oct 9	Design and storytelling	3, 6		
Oct 16	Work class	N/A		
Oct 23	Presentations	1, 2, 3	**A3:** Story/Gameplay "Feel" **A2 DUE**	30%
Oct 30	What is gameplay feel?	2, 3, 4		
Nov 6	Designing for accessibility 1	1		

Nov 13	Work class	N/A		
Nov 20	Presentations	1, 2, 3	**A3 DUE**	
Nov 27	Game Jam	N/A		
Dec 4	Game Jam	N/A		
			Assessment Total:	100%

IMPORTANT DATES:

DATE	IMPORTANT INFORMATION
Mon, Aug 25, 2025	Fall Term Begins
Mon, Sept 1, 2025	Labour Day (No Classes)
Tue, Sept 30, 2025	National Day of Truth and Reconciliation (No Classes)
Fri, Oct 10, 2025	Fall Term Break (No Classes)
Mon, Oct 13, 2025	Thanksgiving Day (No Classes)
Mon, Nov 10, 2025	Voluntary Withdrawal Date
Tue, Nov 11, 2025	Remembrance Day (No Classes)
Fri, Dec 5, 2025	Fall Term Ends

https://www.rrc.ca/future-students/dates/

LETTER GRADE DISTRIBUTION:

A+	4.5	90 to 100%
A	4.0	80 to 89%
B+	3.5	75 to 79%
B	3.0	70 to 74%
C+	2.5	65 to 69%
C	2.0	60 to 64%
D	1.0	50 to 59%
F	0.0	0 - 49%

Minimum performance requirement for this course: D.

To pass the course, students must achieve a grade of 50% or greater on each of their projects.

Course Policies

GENERAL ACADEMIC POLICIES:

It is the student's responsibility to be familiar with and adhere to the RRC Polytech Academic Policies. These Policies can be found in the RRC Polytech calendar or online under Academic Matters at rrc.ca/legal/policies.

SUPPLEMENTARY POLICIES:

Professionalism & Respectful Workplace

Red River College Polytech maintains strict respectful workplace policies. Students are required to maintain a professional demeanour at all times during this course.

Tests & Late Assignment Submissions

1. TESTS

a. All tests or quizzes must be taken on the day and at the time specified by the instructor. Missed tests will not be rescheduled without a valid (/compassionate) reason. Students arriving more than 15 minutes late for exams will not be allowed to write and a mark of zero will be entered. As per college policy A22, item 8.2 – *A student who is unable to write a test or examination due to illness or compassionate grounds must notify the Chair (or instructor) as soon as they become aware of his/her inability to write.*

2. SUBMISSION OF COURSE ASSIGNMENTS

a. All assignments must be submitted on the day and at the time specified by the instructor.

b. *Presentations:* All presentation assignments will follow the late submission guidelines below. If a student misses an assigned presentation date, they must contact the Instructor prior to the date to make other arrangements.

c. *Extensions:* To request an extension on an assignment, the student must provide the Instructor with a valid compassionate reason 48 hours prior to the assignment deadline.

d. *Late submissions:* Will result in an immediate 20% penalty deducted from the assignment mark, and another 20% for each 24 hour period that the assignment is late.

e. Students must complete and submit all course assignments to qualify for a passing grade in this course. If a student has not submitted an assignment by the required deadline, the student is required to contact the Instructor to make arrangements for late submission of work.

f. Unless otherwise specified by the Instructor, all assignments must be submitted as indicated in the assignment instructions. Assignments may not be submitted by e-mail or any other method unless approved in advance by the Instructor.

g. To avoid late penalties do not wait until the last minute to submit work. *Note: Heavy traffic or late buses are not acceptable excuses.*

3. ELECTRONIC COURSE WORK, ASSIGNMENTS, AND FILE MANAGEMENT

Due to the nature of electronic media, students are required to back-up all work at the end of every class or work period to either the cloud or to an external storage device. File management and back-up electronic course work is the responsibility of the student.

Electronic files of assignment work may be requested by the Instructor if there are any concerns regarding work that was submitted for evaluation. Electronic files must be submitted to the Instructor immediately upon request.

Attendance Policies

1. Attendance is mandatory. Due to the nature of the course, students must demonstrate an acceptable level of class participation to qualify for a passing grade. However, if you are sick, we ask that you stay home. You are required to contact your instructors via email or telephone if you will be absent for any reason.

2. If you are absent for six classes of any course without providing your instructor and/or the program coordinator with a valid reason, you will be placed on academic probation and/or terminated from the course. If you are placed on academic probation for absenteeism and continue to be absent from classes without a valid reason, you will be terminated from the program.

3. *Arriving to Class Late:* If a student is late for class and attendance has already been recorded, it is the responsibility of the student to notify the Instructor that they were late. Failure to do so will result in the official attendance record indication that the student was absent for that class. Students arriving more than 15 minutes late may be marked as absent. Instructors may restrict students from late entry to avoid interrupting a class that is already in session.

4. *Leaving Early:* If a student leaves class early without prior approval from the instructor, the student may be marked as absent for that class.

5. *Missed Classes:* Students are responsible for any class work or assignments missed during an absence. If a student misses a class, they are responsible to find out what they missed from a classmate or from Learn, and to catch up on their own time.

6. If an instructor is not present at the beginning of class, and no notice has been posted to indicate that the instructor is ill or when they are expected to arrive, you may leave the class after 20 minutes. Please inform the Chair immediately if this happens.

Plagiarism Policies

1. *Plagiarism*: Presenting another's work as your own is a serious offence. Any student found plagiarizing and/or cheating on any assignment or test may be given a failing grade and risks termination from this course and expulsion from Red River College Polytechnic. Only new original work or material should be submitted.
2. *Self-Plagiarism*: Submitting the same or similar work for credit in more than one course. If a student wishes to submit work that was used in another course, they must first receive Instructor permission, in writing.
3. *Artificial Intelligence (GenAI):* Unauthorized use of AI tools is considered plagiarism. See below.

GENERATIVE AI TOOLS POLICY:

Generative AI systems, such as ChatGPT and Midjourney, are becoming invaluable tools in our industry. However, relying on them to complete your coursework can rob you of an opportunity to learn foundational skills crucial for your success in the game development industry.

In this course, your primary goal is to develop and strengthen your own skills and understanding. While there may be instances where experimenting with and learning about generative AI is encouraged, it is vital that your work remains your own.

POLICY OVERVIEW:

Personal Effort and Understanding: All coursework should be a genuine reflection of your personal effort and understanding.

Prohibited Use: No part of any assignment or project should be generated by an AI tool unless explicitly instructed otherwise by your instructor(s).

Instructor-Directed Use: There may be specific assignments where you will be asked to experiment with and learn about generative AI technology. In these cases, follow the guidelines provided for those assignments.

Consequences: Any submission found to contain AI-generated output will receive a zero. Repeated violations may result in further disciplinary action in accordance with RRC Polytech's Academic Integrity policy.

DATE REVISED:

August 20, 2025

Mental Health and Well-being at RRC Polytech

Having good personal health and well-being will support your success in this program.

WE ENCOURAGE YOU TO:

- Recognize that stress is an expected part of being a college student.
- Rethink how you view difficulty. Being challenged is actually a part of learning and reaching success.
- Reflect on your role in taking care of yourself throughout the term. Do your best to balance your schoolwork and life demands.
- Reach out to your instructor, program coordinator, or College supports at any time if something is affecting your academic performance. It's always best to reach out early and it's the responsible thing to do.

COLLEGE SUPPORTS READY AND WILLING TO ASSIST YOU:

- Academic Success Centre
- Campus Well-Being
- Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Supports
- Health Services
- Indigenous Student Supports
- International Student Supports
- Library Services
- Student Accessibility Services
- Student Counselling Services
- United Way 211 community resource

AUTHORIZATION:

This course is authorized for use by:

Chris Brower
Chair, Digital Media Design and Game Development

August 25, 2025
Date

Approved by Senior Academic Committee March 2025

ALTERNATE FORMATS:

This content is available in alternate formats. To request, please contact accessibility@rrc.ca.